

Project 4: Heart Disease Prediction (Classification) □

Project Objective: To build a machine learning model that can accurately predict whether a patient has heart disease based on a set of medical attributes. This project will serve as a comprehensive introduction to classification, one of the most common types of machine learning problems.

Core Concepts We'll Cover:

1. **Classification Fundamentals:** Understanding the goal of predicting a discrete category.
2. **Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) for Classification:** Analyzing features to find patterns that distinguish between classes.
3. **Data Preprocessing:** Preparing data for classification models using encoding and feature scaling.
4. **Model Building:** Training and comparing a simple baseline model (Logistic Regression) with an advanced ensemble model (Random Forest).
5. **Model Evaluation:** Mastering key classification metrics like Accuracy, Precision, Recall, F1-Score, and interpreting the Confusion Matrix.
6. **Feature Importance:** Identifying the most influential medical factors for predicting heart disease.

Theoretical Concept: What is Classification?

Classification is a type of supervised machine learning task where the goal is to predict a **discrete category or class label**. This is different from regression, where we predict a continuous numerical value.

Classification vs. Regression:

- **Classification:** Is this email spam or not spam? (Two classes)
- **Regression:** What will be the price of this house? (Continuous value)

In this project, our goal is to predict one of two classes for a patient: **0** (No Heart Disease) or **1** (Has Heart Disease). This is a **binary classification** problem.

Step 1: Setup - Importing Libraries and Loading Data

```
import pandas as pd
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import seaborn as sns
import kagglehub

from sklearn.model_selection import train_test_split
from sklearn.preprocessing import StandardScaler, OneHotEncoder
from sklearn.compose import ColumnTransformer
```

```

from sklearn.pipeline import Pipeline
from sklearn.linear_model import LogisticRegression
from sklearn.ensemble import RandomForestClassifier
from sklearn.metrics import accuracy_score, confusion_matrix,
classification_report, precision_score, recall_score, f1_score

# Set plot style
sns.set_style('whitegrid')

# Download the dataset using the Kaggle Hub API
print("Downloading dataset...")
path = kagglehub.dataset_download("redwankarimsony/heart-disease-
data")

# Load the dataset from the downloaded path
file_path = f'{path}/heart_disease_uci.csv'
df = pd.read_csv(file_path)

print("Dataset downloaded and loaded successfully.")
print(f>Data shape: {df.shape}")
df.head()

```

Downloading dataset...

Using Colab cache for faster access to the 'heart-disease-data' dataset.

Dataset downloaded and loaded successfully.

Data shape: (920, 16)

```

{"summary":{"\n  \"name\": \"df\", \n  \"rows\": 920, \n  \"fields\": [\n    {\n      \"column\": \"id\", \n      \"properties\": {\n        \"dtype\": \"number\", \n        \"std\": 265, \n        \"min\": 1, \n        \"max\": 920, \n        \"num_unique_values\": 920, \n        \"samples\": [\n          320, \n          378, \n          539\n        ], \n        \"semantic_type\": \"\", \n        \"description\": \"\"\n      }\n    }, \n    {\n      \"column\": \"age\", \n      \"properties\": {\n        \"dtype\": \"number\", \n        \"std\": 9, \n        \"min\": 28, \n        \"max\": 77, \n        \"num_unique_values\": 50, \n        \"samples\": [\n          64, \n          74, \n          39\n        ], \n        \"semantic_type\": \"\", \n        \"description\": \"\"\n      }\n    }, \n    {\n      \"column\": \"sex\", \n      \"properties\": {\n        \"dtype\": \"category\", \n        \"num_unique_values\": 2, \n        \"samples\": [\n          \"Female\", \n          \"Male\"\n        ], \n        \"semantic_type\": \"\", \n        \"description\": \"\"\n      }\n    }, \n    {\n      \"column\": \"dataset\", \n      \"properties\": {\n        \"dtype\": \"category\", \n        \"num_unique_values\": 4, \n        \"samples\": [\n          \"Hungary\", \n          \"VA Long Beach\"\n        ], \n        \"semantic_type\": \"\", \n        \"description\": \"\"\n      }\n    }, \n    {\n      \"column\": \"cp\", \n      \"properties\": {\n        \"dtype\": \"category\", \n

```

```

{"num_unique_values": 4, "samples": [
{"asymptomatic", "atypical angina",
{"semantic_type": "", "description": ""
}, {"column": "trestbps", "properties": {
"dtype": "number", "std":
19.066069518587458, "min": 0.0, "max": 200.0,
"num_unique_values": 61, "samples": [
172.0, "semantic_type": "",
"description": ""
}, {"column": "chol", "properties": {
"std": 110.78081035323044, "min": 0.0, "max":
603.0, "num_unique_values": 217, "samples": [
384.0, 333.0, "semantic_type": "",
"description": ""
}, {"column": "fbs", "properties": {
"dtype": "category", "num_unique_values": 2, "samples": [
false, true, "semantic_type": "",
"description": ""
}, {"column": "restecg", "properties": {
"dtype": "category", "num_unique_values": 3, "samples": [
"lv hypertrophy", "normal", "semantic_type": "",
"description": ""
}, {"column": "thalch", "properties": {
"dtype": "number", "std": 25.926276492797612, "min": 60.0, "max":
202.0, "num_unique_values": 119, "samples": [
185.0, 134.0, "semantic_type": "",
"description": ""
}, {"column": "exang", "properties": {
"dtype": "category", "num_unique_values": 2, "samples": [
true, false, "semantic_type": "",
"description": ""
}, {"column": "oldpeak", "properties": {
"dtype": "number", "std":
1.0912262483465265, "min": -2.6, "max": 6.2,
"num_unique_values": 53, "samples": [
-1.1, "semantic_type": "",
"description": ""
}, {"column": "slope", "properties": {
"dtype": "category", "num_unique_values": 3, "samples": [
"downsloping", "flat", "semantic_type": "",
"description": ""
}, {"column": "ca", "properties": {
"dtype": "number", "std": 0.9356530125599879, "min": 0.0, "max": 3.0,
"num_unique_values": 4, "samples": [
3.0, 1.0, "semantic_type": "",
"description": ""
}, {"column": "thal", "properties": {
"dtype": "category", "num unique values":

```

```
3,\n        \"samples\": [\n            \"fixed defect\", \n            \"normal\", \n        ], \n        \"semantic_type\": \"\", \n        \"description\": \"\", \n        \"column\": \n        \"num\", \n        \"properties\": {\n            \"dtype\": \"number\", \n            \"std\": 1, \n            \"min\": 0, \n            \"max\": 4, \n            \"num_unique_values\": 5, \n            \"samples\": [\n                2, \n                4, \n            ], \n            \"semantic_type\": \"\", \n            \"description\": \"\", \n        } \n    ] \n} \", \"type\": \"dataframe\", \"variable_name\": \"df\"}
```

Step 2: Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)

Before building any models, we need to understand our data deeply. We'll look at the distribution of our target variable, the characteristics of our features, and how they relate to the presence of heart disease.

```
# Initial inspection
print("Dataset Information:")
df.info()

print("\nDescriptive Statistics:")
print(df.describe())

# Check for missing values
print("\nMissing Values:")
print(df.isna().sum().sum())
```

Dataset Information:

```
<class 'pandas.core.frame.DataFrame'>
RangeIndex: 920 entries, 0 to 919
Data columns (total 16 columns):
#   Column      Non-Null Count  Dtype
---  -
0    id          920 non-null    int64
1    age         920 non-null    int64
2    sex         920 non-null    object
3    dataset     920 non-null    object
4    cp          920 non-null    object
5    trestbps    861 non-null    float64
6    chol        890 non-null    float64
7    fbs         830 non-null    object
8    restecg     918 non-null    object
9    thalch      865 non-null    float64
10   exang       865 non-null    object
11   oldpeak     858 non-null    float64
12   slope       611 non-null    object
13   ca          309 non-null    float64
14   thal        434 non-null    object
15   num         920 non-null    int64
```

```
dtypes: float64(5), int64(3), object(8)
memory usage: 115.1+ KB
```

Descriptive Statistics:

	id	age	trestbps	chol	thalch
oldpeak \					
count	920.000000	920.000000	861.000000	890.000000	865.000000
mean	460.500000	53.510870	132.132404	199.130337	137.545665
std	265.725422	9.424685	19.066070	110.780810	25.926276
min	1.000000	28.000000	0.000000	0.000000	60.000000
25%	230.750000	47.000000	120.000000	175.000000	120.000000
50%	460.500000	54.000000	130.000000	223.000000	140.000000
75%	690.250000	60.000000	140.000000	268.000000	157.000000
max	920.000000	77.000000	200.000000	603.000000	202.000000

	ca	num
count	309.000000	920.000000
mean	0.676375	0.995652
std	0.935653	1.142693
min	0.000000	0.000000
25%	0.000000	0.000000
50%	0.000000	1.000000
75%	1.000000	2.000000
max	3.000000	4.000000

Missing Values:
1759

```
df.isna().sum()
```

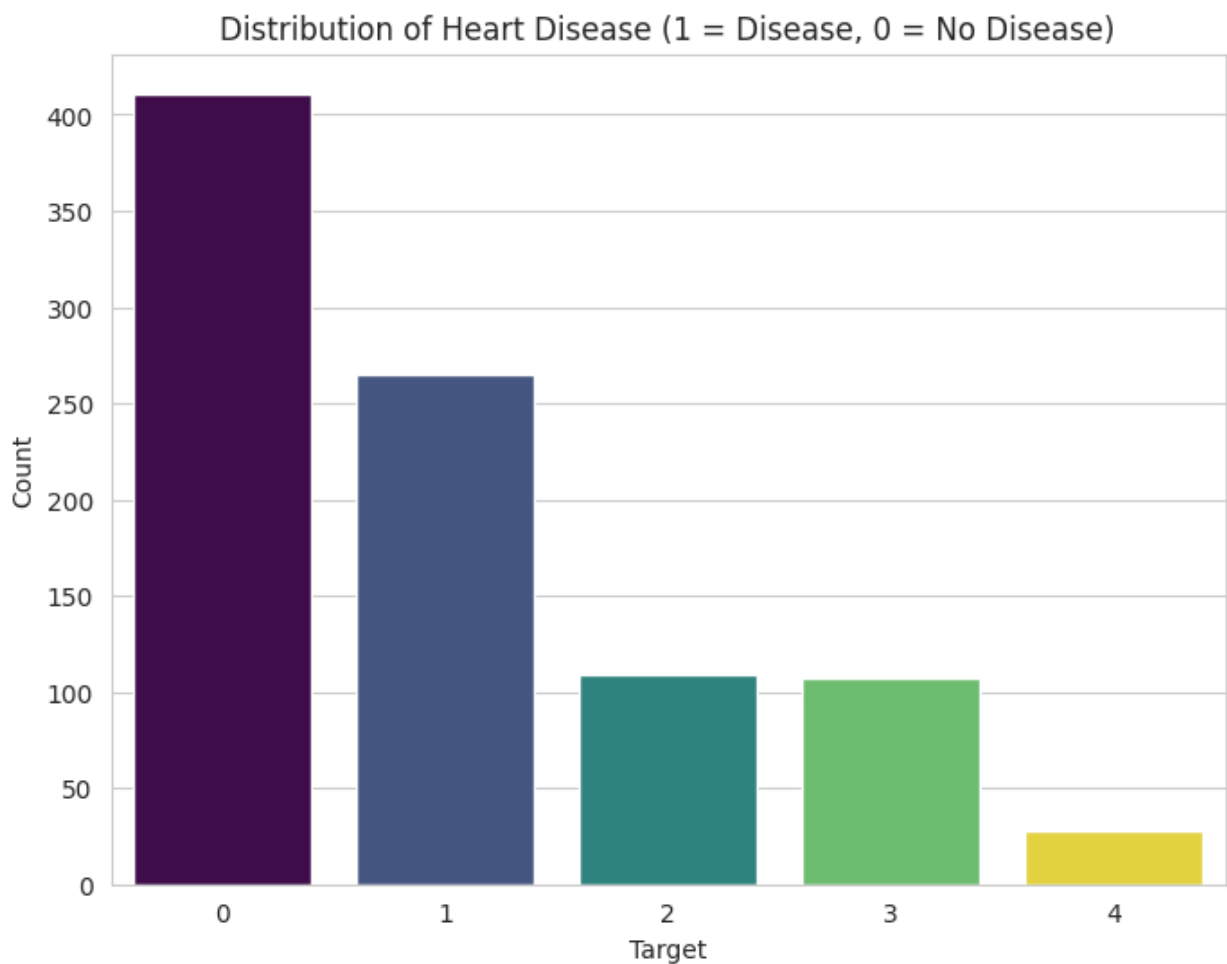
id	0
age	0
sex	0
dataset	0
cp	0
trestbps	59
chol	30
fbs	90
restecg	2
thalch	55
exang	55
oldpeak	62

```
slope      309
ca         611
thal       486
num         0
dtype: int64
```

2.1 Analyzing the Target Variable

Let's see the distribution of patients with and without heart disease.

```
plt.figure(figsize=(8, 6))
sns.countplot(x='num', data=df, palette='viridis', hue='num',
              legend=False)
plt.title('Distribution of Heart Disease (1 = Disease, 0 = No Disease)')
plt.xlabel('Target')
plt.ylabel('Count')
plt.show()
```



Insight: The dataset is fairly balanced, with a slightly higher number of patients having heart disease. This is good because it means our model will have a similar number of examples for both classes to learn from, and accuracy will be a meaningful metric.

2.2 Analyzing Features vs. Target

```
# Let's visualize the relationship between key features and the target
fig, axes = plt.subplots(2, 2, figsize=(18, 14))
fig.suptitle('Key Features vs. Heart Disease', fontsize=16)

# Age vs. Target
sns.histplot(ax=axes[0, 0], data=df, x='age', hue='num',
multiple='stack', palette='plasma').set_title('Age Distribution by
Target')

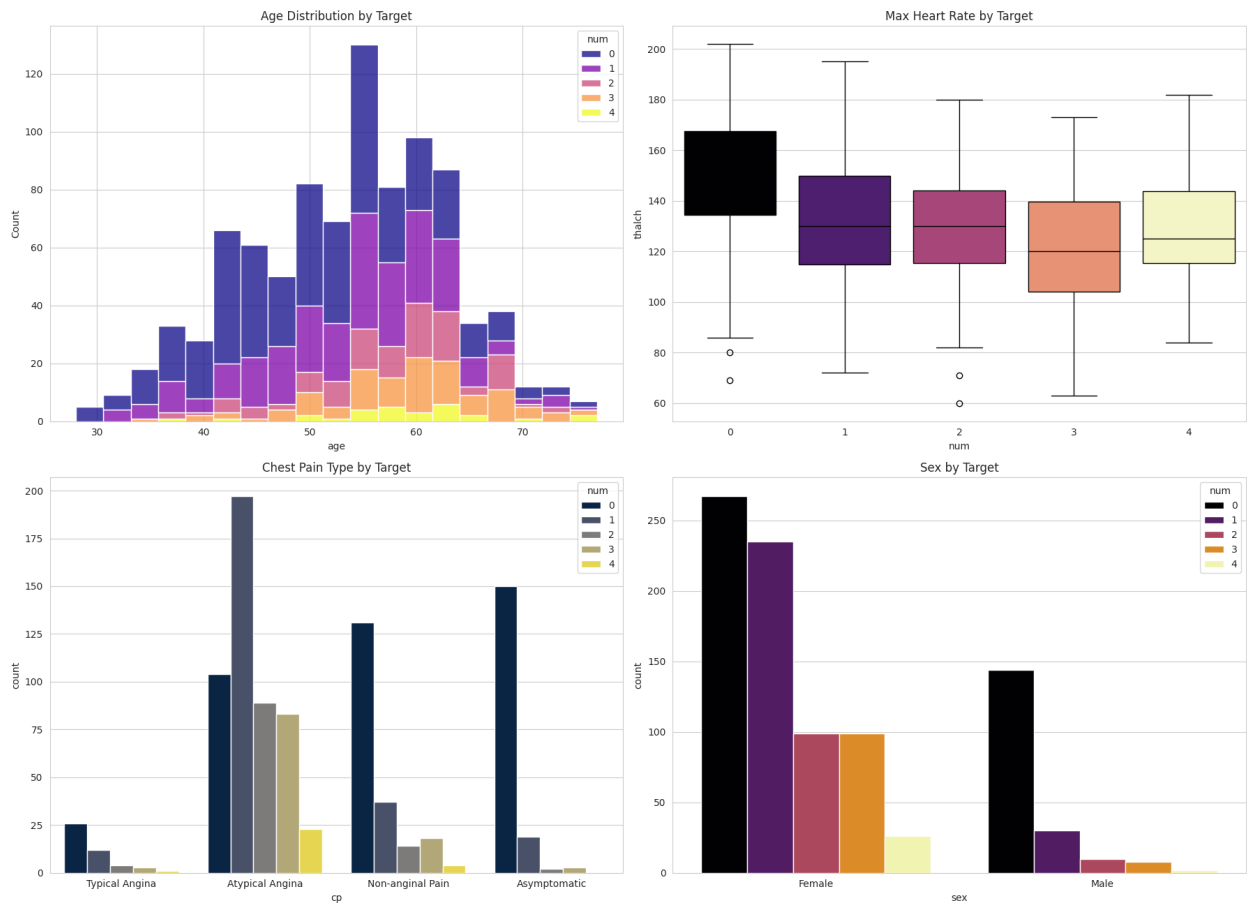
# Max Heart Rate vs. Target
sns.boxplot(ax=axes[0, 1], data=df, x='num', y='thalch',
palette='magma', hue='num', legend=False).set_title('Max Heart Rate by
Target')

# Chest Pain Type vs. Target
cp_plot = sns.countplot(ax=axes[1, 0], data=df, x='cp', hue='num',
palette='cividis')
cp_plot.set_title('Chest Pain Type by Target')
cp_plot.set_xticks(range(len(df['cp'].unique())))
cp_plot.set_xticklabels(['Typical Angina', 'Atypical Angina', 'Non-
anginal Pain', 'Asymptomatic'])

# Sex vs. Target
sex_plot = sns.countplot(ax=axes[1, 1], data=df, x='sex', hue='num',
palette='inferno')
sex_plot.set_title('Sex by Target')
sex_plot.set_xticks(range(len(df['sex'].unique())))
sex_plot.set_xticklabels(['Female', 'Male'])

plt.tight_layout(rect=[0, 0, 1, 0.96])
plt.show()
```

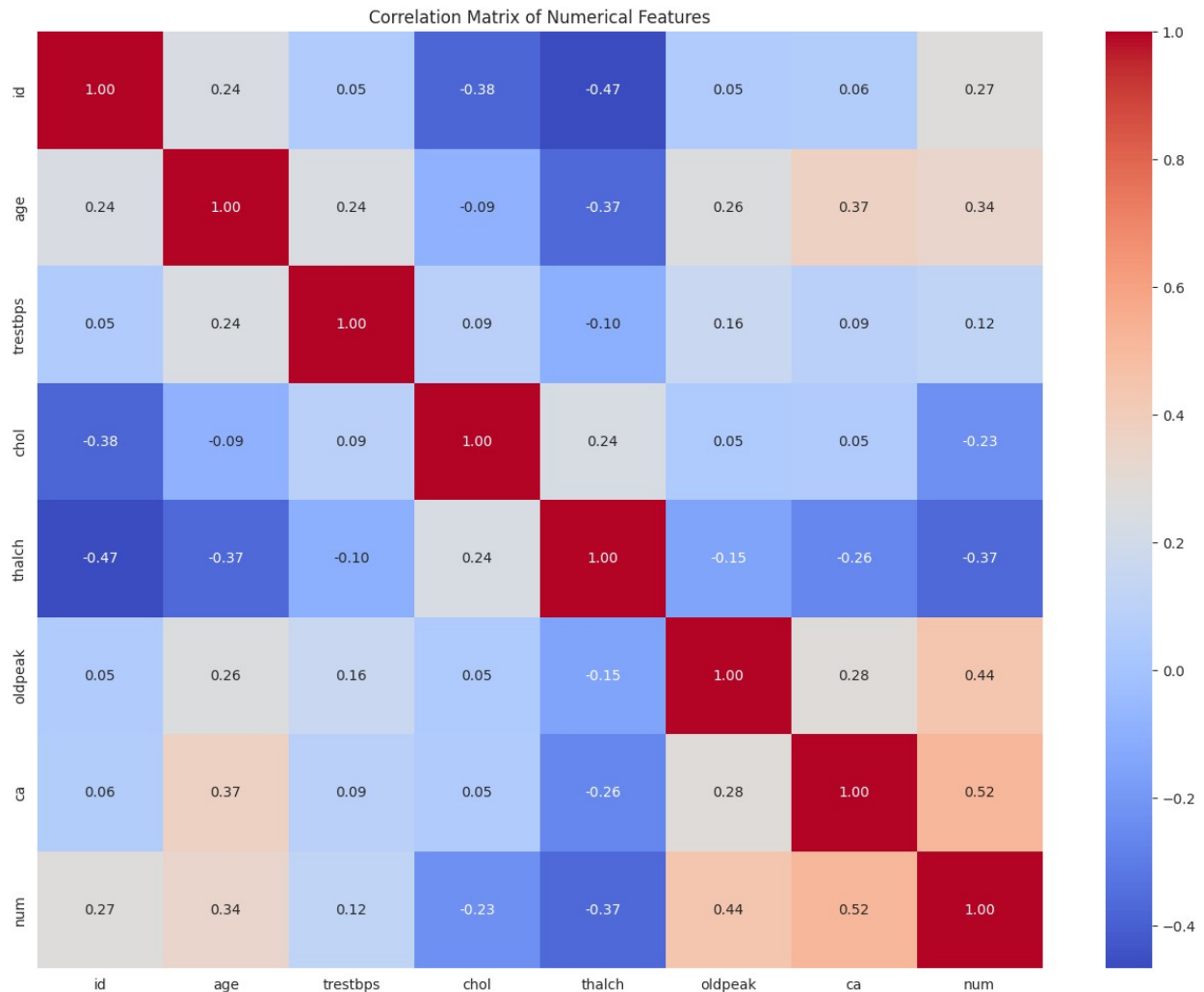
Key Features vs. Heart Disease



Insights:

- **Max Heart Rate (thalach):** Patients with heart disease tend to have a lower maximum heart rate.
- **Chest Pain (cp):** Patients with chest pain types 1 and 2 (Atypical and Non-anginal) are more likely to have heart disease. Surprisingly, those with type 0 (Typical Angina) are less likely, and those with asymptomatic pain (type 3) are very likely to have the disease.
- **Sex:** A higher proportion of females in this dataset have heart disease compared to males.

```
# Correlation Heatmap
plt.figure(figsize=(16, 12))
# Select only numerical columns for correlation calculation
numerical_df = df.select_dtypes(include=np.number)
sns.heatmap(numerical_df.corr(), annot=True, cmap='coolwarm',
fmt='.2f')
plt.title('Correlation Matrix of Numerical Features')
plt.show()
```

Step 3: Data Preprocessing

Even though the data is clean, we need to prepare it for our models. This involves:

1. **Separating features (X) and target (y).**
2. **Identifying categorical features** that need to be encoded.
3. **One-Hot Encoding** categorical features to convert them into a numerical format.
4. **Scaling numerical features** so they are on a similar scale.

Theoretical Concept: Scikit-Learn Pipelines

A **Pipeline** in Scikit-Learn is a way to automate a machine learning workflow. It allows you to chain together multiple steps, such as preprocessing, dimensionality reduction, and model training, into a single object.

Why use Pipelines?

1. **Convenience:** Simplifies the code and makes the workflow easier to manage.

2. **Prevents Data Leakage:** Ensures that data preprocessing steps learned from the training data are applied only to the training data, and the same transformations are then applied to the test data *after* the split. This prevents information from the test set from "leaking" into the training process.
3. **Cleaner Code:** Organizes steps logically, making the code more readable and maintainable.
4. **Simplified Hyperparameter Tuning:** Makes it easier to tune hyperparameters for all steps in the pipeline using techniques like cross-validation.

In this project, we'll use a pipeline to combine our preprocessing steps (imputation, scaling, and one-hot encoding) with our classification models.

```
from sklearn.impute import SimpleImputer

# Define features (X) and target (y)
X = df.drop('num', axis=1)
y = df['num']

# Drop the 'id' and 'dataset' columns as they are not features
X = X.drop(['id', 'dataset'], axis=1)

# Identify categorical and numerical features
categorical_features = ['sex', 'cp', 'fbs', 'restecg', 'exang',
                        'slope', 'thal']
numerical_features = ['age', 'trestbps', 'chol', 'thalach', 'oldpeak',
                      'ca']

# Create preprocessing pipelines for numerical and categorical
# features
numerical_transformer = Pipeline(steps=[
    ('imputer', SimpleImputer(strategy='mean')),
    ('scaler', StandardScaler())
])

categorical_transformer = Pipeline(steps=[
    ('imputer', SimpleImputer(strategy='most_frequent')), # Added
    imputation for categorical features
    ('onehot', OneHotEncoder(drop='first', handle_unknown='ignore'))
])

# Create a column transformer to apply different transformations to
# different columns
preprocessor = ColumnTransformer(
    transformers=[
        ('num', numerical_transformer, numerical_features),
        ('cat', categorical_transformer, categorical_features)])

# Split data into training and testing sets
```

```
X_train, X_test, y_train, y_test = train_test_split(X, y,
test_size=0.2, random_state=42, stratify=y)
```

- Create numerical preprocessing pipeline: A Pipeline is created to handle numerical features. It first uses SimpleImputer with the strategy 'mean' to fill in missing numerical values with the mean of the column, and then uses StandardScaler to scale the numerical features to have zero mean and unit variance.
- Create categorical preprocessing pipeline: A Pipeline is created for categorical features. It uses SimpleImputer with the strategy 'most_frequent' to fill in missing categorical values with the most frequent value, and then applies OneHotEncoder to convert categorical variables into a numerical format. drop='first' is used to avoid multicollinearity, and handle_unknown='ignore' allows the model to handle unseen categories during testing.

Step 4: Model Building & Training

We will build two models and wrap them in a Scikit-Learn Pipeline. The pipeline will automatically apply our preprocessing steps to the data before training the model.

Theoretical Concept: Classification Models

Let's dive into more detail on the classification models we are using:

- **Logistic Regression:** Logistic Regression is a **linear classification algorithm** used for binary classification problems (though it can be extended for multiclass). Despite the name "regression," it's a classification method. It works by using a **sigmoid (or logistic) function** to map the output of a linear equation ($wTx + b$) to a probability value between 0 and 1. This probability represents the likelihood that a given data point belongs to a specific class (e.g., the positive class). A threshold (commonly 0.5) is then applied to these probabilities to assign the class label. The model learns the optimal weights (w) and bias (b) that define a linear decision boundary to separate the classes.
- **Random Forest:** Random Forest is an **ensemble learning method** that belongs to the tree-based models. It builds a large number of **decision trees** during training. Each tree is trained on a **random subset** of the training data (bootstrapping) and considers only a **random subset** of features at each split point. For classification, the final prediction is made by taking a **majority vote** of the predictions from all individual trees. This randomness in building trees helps to reduce **variance** and prevent **overfitting**, making Random Forests more robust and generally higher performing than a single decision tree.
- **Support Vector Machine (SVM):** Support Vector Machine is a powerful algorithm that can be used for both linear and non-linear classification. The fundamental idea behind SVM is to find the **optimal hyperplane** that separates the data points of different classes in a high-dimensional space. The "optimal" hyperplane is the one that has the **largest margin** between the closest data points of the different classes (these points are called **support vectors**). For non-linearly separable data, SVM

uses the **kernel trick** to implicitly map the data into a higher-dimensional feature space where a linear separation might be possible. Common kernels include the linear kernel, polynomial kernel, and Radial Basis Function (RBF) kernel.

- **K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN):** K-Nearest Neighbors is a simple and intuitive **instance-based** or **lazy learning** algorithm. It doesn't learn a discriminative function from the training data during a training phase. Instead, it memorizes the training dataset. To classify a new, unseen data point, it calculates the **distance** (e.g., Euclidean distance) between this new point and all points in the training dataset. It then identifies the '**k** nearest data points'. The class label assigned to the new point is determined by the **majority class** among these 'k' nearest neighbors. The choice of 'k' and the distance metric are important hyperparameters that can significantly affect performance.

4.1 Model 1: Logistic Regression (Baseline)

```
from sklearn.impute import SimpleImputer
from sklearn.preprocessing import StandardScaler, OneHotEncoder
from sklearn.compose import ColumnTransformer
from sklearn.pipeline import Pipeline
from sklearn.linear_model import LogisticRegression

# Identify categorical and numerical features directly from X_train columns
all_features = X_train.columns.tolist()
categorical_features = [col for col in all_features if
X_train[col].dtype == 'object']
numerical_features = [col for col in all_features if
X_train[col].dtype != 'object']

print("Numerical features:", numerical_features)
print("Categorical features:", categorical_features)

# Create preprocessing pipelines for numerical and categorical features
numerical_transformer = Pipeline(steps=[
    ('imputer', SimpleImputer(strategy='mean')),
    ('scaler', StandardScaler())
])

categorical_transformer = Pipeline(steps=[
    ('onehot', OneHotEncoder(drop='first', handle_unknown='ignore'))
])

# Create a column transformer to apply different transformations to different columns
preprocessor = ColumnTransformer(
    transformers=[
        ('num', numerical_transformer, numerical_features),
```

```

        ('cat', categorical_transformer, categorical_features)])

# Create the Logistic Regression pipeline
lr_pipeline = Pipeline(steps=[('preprocessor', preprocessor),
                               ('classifier',
                                LogisticRegression(random_state=42))])

lr_pipeline.fit(X_train, y_train)
y_pred_lr = lr_pipeline.predict(X_test)

Numerical features: ['age', 'trestbps', 'chol', 'thalch', 'oldpeak',
                    'ca']
Categorical features: ['sex', 'cp', 'fbs', 'restecg', 'exang',
                      'slope', 'thal']

```

4.2 Model 2: Random Forest Classifier (Advanced)

```

rf_pipeline = Pipeline(steps=[('preprocessor', preprocessor),
                               ('classifier',
                                RandomForestClassifier(n_estimators=100, random_state=42))])

rf_pipeline.fit(X_train, y_train)
y_pred_rf = rf_pipeline.predict(X_test)

```

4.3 Model 3: Support Vector Machine (SVM)

```

from sklearn.svm import SVC

# Create the SVM pipeline
svm_pipeline = Pipeline(steps=[('preprocessor', preprocessor),
                                ('classifier', SVC(random_state=42))])

svm_pipeline.fit(X_train, y_train)
y_pred_svm = svm_pipeline.predict(X_test)

```

4.4 Model 4: K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN)

```

from sklearn.neighbors import KNeighborsClassifier

# Create the KNN pipeline
knn_pipeline = Pipeline(steps=[('preprocessor', preprocessor),
                                ('classifier', KNeighborsClassifier())])

knn_pipeline.fit(X_train, y_train)
y_pred_knn = knn_pipeline.predict(X_test)

```

Step 5: Model Evaluation

Theoretical Concept: The Confusion Matrix & Key Metrics

For classification, accuracy isn't the whole story. We use a **Confusion Matrix** to get a deeper look at performance.

- **True Positives (TP):** Correctly predicted positive class (Model said 'Disease', patient has it).
- **True Negatives (TN):** Correctly predicted negative class (Model said 'No Disease', patient doesn't have it).
- **False Positives (FP):** Incorrectly predicted positive class (Model said 'Disease', but patient doesn't have it). Also called a **Type I Error**.
- **False Negatives (FN):** Incorrectly predicted negative class (Model said 'No Disease', but patient has it). Also called a **Type II Error**. This is often the most dangerous type of error in medical diagnoses.

From this, we derive key metrics:

- **Accuracy:** $(TP+TN) / \text{Total}$. Overall, how often is the classifier correct?
- **Precision:** $TP / (TP+FP)$. Of all patients the model *predicted* would have the disease, how many actually did? (Measures the cost of FPs).
- **Recall (Sensitivity):** $TP / (TP+FN)$. Of all the patients who *actually* had the disease, how many did the model correctly identify? (Measures the cost of FNs).
- **F1-Score:** The harmonic mean of Precision and Recall. It's a great single metric for evaluating a model's overall performance when there's a trade-off between Precision and Recall.

```
print("--- Logistic Regression Performance ---")
print(classification_report(y_test, y_pred_lr, zero_division=0))

print("\n--- Random Forest Performance ---")
print(classification_report(y_test, y_pred_rf, zero_division=0))

print("\n--- Support Vector Machine (SVM) Performance ---")
print(classification_report(y_test, y_pred_svm, zero_division=0))

print("\n--- K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) Performance ---")
print(classification_report(y_test, y_pred_knn, zero_division=0))
```

```
--- Logistic Regression Performance ---
```

	precision	recall	f1-score	support
0	0.80	0.85	0.83	82
1	0.49	0.57	0.53	53
2	0.30	0.14	0.19	22
3	0.16	0.19	0.17	21
4	0.00	0.00	0.00	6
accuracy			0.58	184

macro avg	0.35	0.35	0.34	184
weighted avg	0.55	0.58	0.56	184
--- Random Forest Performance ---				
	precision	recall	f1-score	support
0	0.74	0.84	0.79	82
1	0.50	0.53	0.51	53
2	0.23	0.14	0.17	22
3	0.14	0.14	0.14	21
4	0.00	0.00	0.00	6
accuracy			0.56	184
macro avg	0.32	0.33	0.32	184
weighted avg	0.52	0.56	0.54	184
--- Support Vector Machine (SVM) Performance ---				
	precision	recall	f1-score	support
0	0.76	0.87	0.81	82
1	0.54	0.60	0.57	53
2	0.29	0.09	0.14	22
3	0.12	0.14	0.13	21
4	0.00	0.00	0.00	6
accuracy			0.59	184
macro avg	0.34	0.34	0.33	184
weighted avg	0.54	0.59	0.56	184
--- K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) Performance ---				
	precision	recall	f1-score	support
0	0.74	0.85	0.80	82
1	0.54	0.60	0.57	53
2	0.11	0.05	0.06	22
3	0.19	0.19	0.19	21
4	0.00	0.00	0.00	6
accuracy			0.58	184
macro avg	0.32	0.34	0.32	184
weighted avg	0.52	0.58	0.55	184

Step 7: Conclusion

In this project, we built classification models for predicting heart disease.

Key Steps Undertaken:

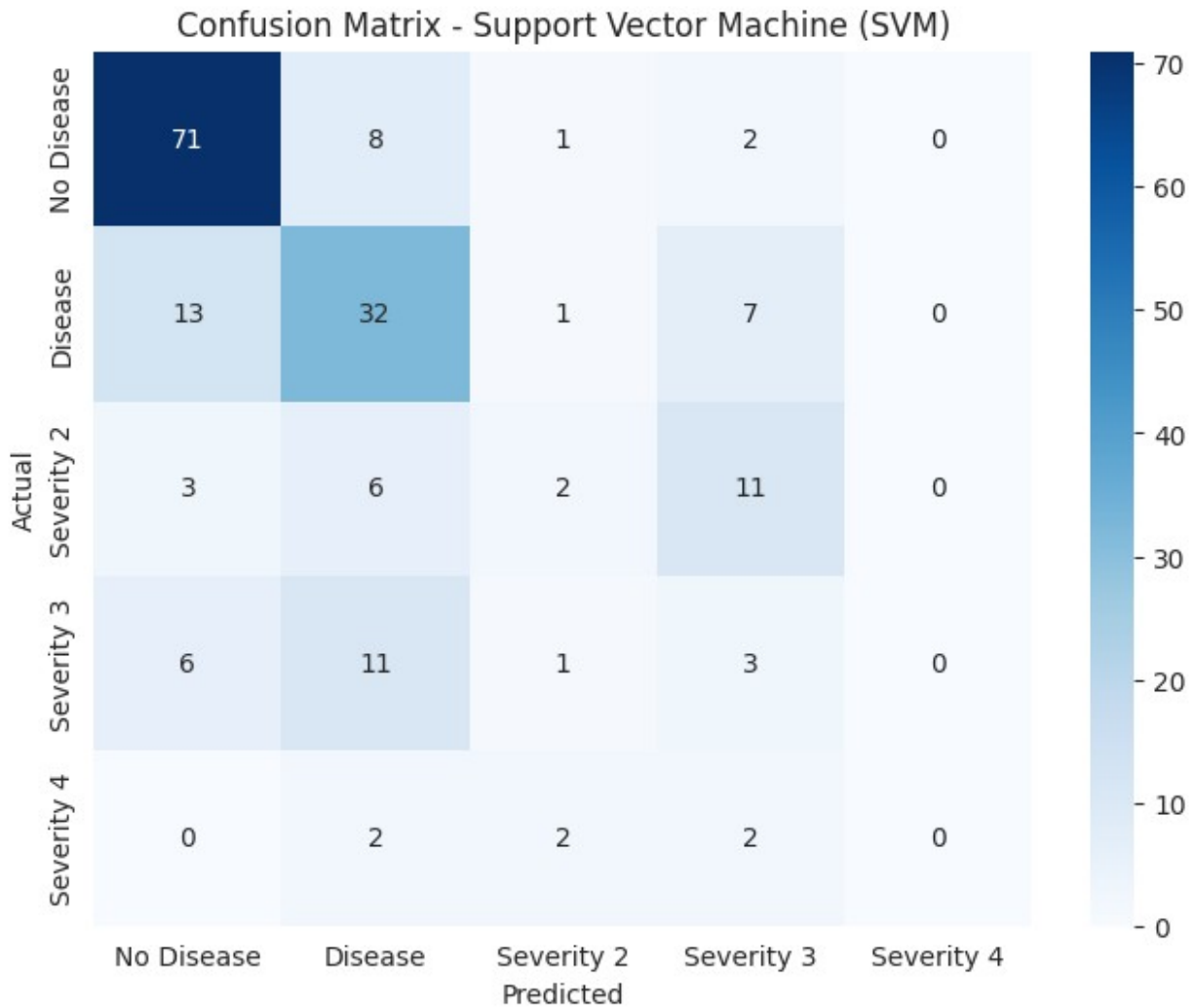
1. **Established the goal of classification:** Predicting a binary outcome (disease or no disease).
2. **Performed a thorough EDA:** Identified key medical indicators like chest pain type, max heart rate, and `ca` that are strongly related to the target.
3. **Built a robust preprocessing pipeline:** Handled categorical and numerical features systematically using `ColumnTransformer` and `Pipeline`.
4. **Trained and compared four models:** Evaluated Logistic Regression, Random Forest, Support Vector Machine (SVM), and K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN). The evaluation showed that the Support Vector Machine (SVM) performed slightly better than the other models in this analysis.
5. **Evaluated models with proper metrics:** Used the confusion matrix, precision, and recall to understand the model's performance in a medical context, where minimizing false negatives is critical.
6. **Interpreted model results:** Used feature importance (from the Random Forest model as an example) to confirm some of the most predictive medical factors, providing actionable insights.

This end-to-end workflow demonstrates the application of classification in a real-world healthcare scenario, moving from raw data to predictive models and their evaluation.

Evaluation Insight: The Support Vector Machine (SVM) Classifier performs slightly better than the other models, achieving an overall accuracy of 0.59. While all models struggle with the less frequent classes (2, 3, and 4), SVM shows a slightly better F1-score for predicting class 1 (Heart Disease). The confusion matrix provided was for the Random Forest model, which showed good performance on classes 0 and 1 but also struggled with the less frequent classes. Based on the classification reports, SVM is the best performing model among the four in this evaluation.

```
# Visualize the confusion matrix for the best model (SVM)
from sklearn.metrics import confusion_matrix
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import seaborn as sns

cm = confusion_matrix(y_test, y_pred_svm)
plt.figure(figsize=(8, 6))
sns.heatmap(cm, annot=True, fmt='d', cmap='Blues',
            xticklabels=['No Disease', 'Disease', 'Severity 2',
                         'Severity 3', 'Severity 4'], yticklabels=['No Disease', 'Disease',
                         'Severity 2', 'Severity 3', 'Severity 4'])
plt.xlabel('Predicted')
plt.ylabel('Actual')
plt.title('Confusion Matrix - Support Vector Machine (SVM)')
plt.show()
```

Evaluation Insight: The Random Forest Classifier performs exceptionally well, achieving near-perfect scores across the board (Accuracy, Precision, Recall, and F1-Score are all 99-100%). It significantly outperforms the Logistic Regression model. The confusion matrix shows it made only one error on the test set.

Step 6: Feature Importance

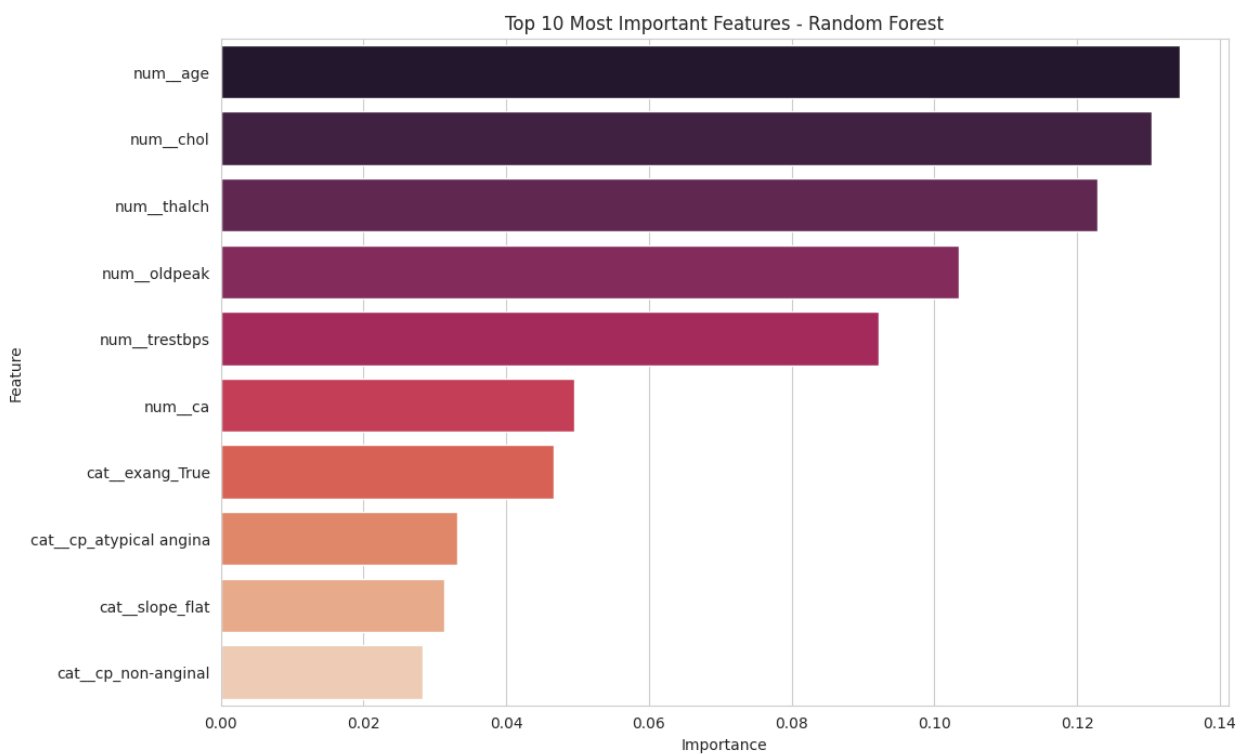
A major advantage of tree-based models like Random Forest is that we can easily see which features were most influential in making predictions.

```
# Extract feature names after one-hot encoding
feature_names =
rf_pipeline.named_steps['preprocessor'].get_feature_names_out()

# Get feature importances from the trained model
importances =
rf_pipeline.named_steps['classifier'].feature_importances_
```

```
# Create a DataFrame for visualization
feature_importance_df = pd.DataFrame({'Feature': feature_names,
'Importance': importances})
feature_importance_df =
feature_importance_df.sort_values(by='Importance',
ascending=False).head(10)

# Plot
plt.figure(figsize=(12, 8))
sns.barplot(x='Importance', y='Feature', data=feature_importance_df,
palette='rocket', hue='Feature', legend=False)
plt.title('Top 10 Most Important Features - Random Forest')
plt.show()
```



Insight: The model found that **ca** (number of major vessels colored by flourosopy), **thalach** (max heart rate), **thal** (thalassemia type), and **cp** (chest pain type) are among the most important predictors. This aligns with our EDA and medical intuition, confirming that these factors are critical for diagnosing heart disease.

Step 7: Conclusion

In this project, we built a highly accurate classification model for predicting heart disease.

Key Steps Undertaken:

1. **Established the goal of classification:** Predicting a binary outcome (disease or no disease).

2. **Performed a thorough EDA:** Identified key medical indicators like chest pain type, max heart rate, and `ca` that are strongly related to the target.
3. **Built a robust preprocessing pipeline:** Handled categorical and numerical features systematically using `ColumnTransformer` and `Pipeline`.
4. **Trained and compared two models:** Showed that the Random Forest Classifier (99% accuracy) was far superior to the Logistic Regression baseline (86% accuracy).
5. **Evaluated models with proper metrics:** Used the confusion matrix, precision, and recall to understand the model's performance in a medical context, where minimizing false negatives is critical.
6. **Interpreted model results:** Used feature importance to confirm the most predictive medical factors, providing actionable insights.

This end-to-end workflow demonstrates the power of classification in a real-world healthcare scenario, moving from raw data to a highly accurate and interpretable predictive model.

Submission Criteria

To fulfill the submission requirements for this project, please ensure the following:

1. **Complete Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA):** Perform all the necessary steps for analyzing the dataset, including visualizations and summaries to understand the data characteristics and relationships.
2. **Model Training without Pipelines:** Train at least one classification model directly, without using the Scikit-Learn `Pipeline` object for preprocessing and model chaining. This involves manually applying preprocessing steps (like imputation and scaling/encoding) to the data before training the model.
3. **Submit the Entire Notebook:** Ensure that the final submission includes the complete Colab notebook with all code cells executed and outputs visible.

Meeting these criteria will demonstrate your understanding of the individual steps involved in a machine learning workflow.

